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General Comment

Current copyright laws are not “unnecessarily burdensome” on AI development, they are extremely necessary. They protect intellectual property. The fact that true, original creation by individuals can be protected by copyright helps to facilitate a strong economy—it is essential to the free market to function. If creators of art, video, photography, and written materials cannot protect their means of making money, they cannot participate in keeping the economy circulating.

AI should not be able to use copyrighted materials without permission from the copyright holder. AI cannot make anything original or with thought, the way human can—it can only regurgitate the materials that are inputted into the program. If these are stolen from copyrighted materials, AI should not be able to create materials that hold a copyright itself, as it was used unlawfully and unethically. AI is currently too unregulated. To get ahead globally, in the long term, we must look ahead—utilize AI ethically, without using copyrighted materials without permission, without harming the environment by using copious amounts of water, and fact check the AI so it can’t cause misinformation—then you will have an amazing product ahead of any other countries that are attempting to use AI without regulating it. You’ll have something everyone can support. As other AI programs crash around the world when they are litigated against and hated by the population for stealing work, AI in the US will remain because it had a strong foundation by creating thoughtful regulations before it grew too big too fast. Unregulated AI is the hare, and regulated AI is the tortoise. AI will be supported and widely used by creators, if it is not stealing their work, harming their environment, or taking their jobs. Employment makes a happy economy. Automating enjoyable jobs means no one will have the money to spend to keep the economy healthy.